

A Division of Tandy Corporation

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**TANDY'S DESKMATE SOFTWARE
UTILIZES ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE METHODS**

FORT WORTH, Texas (September 28, 1989) -- Tandy Corporation is promoting its DeskMate® software as "The Friendly Face in the PC Crowd" with its easy-to-use graphical interface, context sensitive help and on-line tutorials.

Dr. Scott Cutler, vice president of Tandy Computer Software Design, explained how a 300-page reference manual was replaced by using an extensive set of on line tutorials and context sensitive help based on artificial intelligence, techniques used to further enhance DeskMate's ease of use.

"Last year, DeskMate came with two basic manuals -- a 64-page, magazine-style introduction and a 300-page reference manual. This year, the magazine has expanded to 90 pages, but the 300-page reference manual is gone. It has been replaced by an extensive set of on-line tutorials and a context sensitive help system with an artificial intelligence underpinning," Dr. Cutler pointed out.

He added that the DeskMate interface, which is licensed to more than 100 software developers, also includes a set of "hooks" that allows the help system to know where the user is within any DeskMate application and what the user has done. This allows application developers to write context sensitive help files for all previously released DeskMate applications as well as future applications.

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